



University of Papua New Guinea

School of Natural and Physical Sciences

Department of Mathematics, Statistics and Computer Science

Address: PO Box 320 University PO Waigani, Port Moresby, Phone: 326 7414, Email: secmaths@upng.ac.pg

Python Dictionary



- A Python dictionary is a collection of key-value pairs where each key is associated with a value.
- A value in the key-value pair can be a number, a string, a list, a tuple, or even another dictionary.
- In fact, you can use a value of any valid type in Python as the value in the key-value pair.
- A key in the key-value pair must be immutable.
- In other words, the key cannot be changed, for example, a number, a string, a tuple, etc.
- Python uses the curly braces {} to define a dictionary.
- Inside the curly braces, you can place zero, one, or many key-value pairs.



Example defines an empty dictionary:

```
empty_dict = {}
```

```
print(type(empty_dict))
```

Ouput:

```
<class 'dict'>
```

```
person = {  
    'first_name': 'John',  
    'last_name': 'Doe',  
    'age': 25,  
    'favorite_colors': ['blue', 'green'],  
    'active': True  
}
```



Accessing values in a Dictionary:

1) Using square bracket notation:

```
person = {  
    'first_name': 'John',  
    'last_name': 'Doe',  
    'age': 25,  
    'favorite_colors': ['blue', 'green'],  
    'active': True  
}
```

```
print(person['first_name'])  
print(person['last_name'])
```



2) Using the get() method

```
person = {  
    'first_name': 'John',  
    'last_name': 'Doe',  
    'age': 25,  
    'favorite_colors': ['blue', 'green'],  
    'active': True  
}
```

```
name= person.get('first_name')  
print(name)
```

#Adding new & modifying existing key-value pairs:

```
person['gender'] = 'Famale'  
person['age'] = 26
```

```
print(person)
```



Removing key-value pairs:

```
person = {  
    'first_name': 'John',  
    'last_name': 'Doe',  
    'age': 25,  
    'favorite_colors': ['blue', 'green'],  
    'active': True  
}
```

```
del person['active']  
print(person)
```



Looping through a dictionary:

1) Looping all key-value pairs in a dictionary:

- Python dictionary provides a method called **items()** that returns an object which contains a list of key-value pairs as tuples in a list.

For example:

```
person = {  
    'first_name': 'John',  
    'last_name': 'Doe',  
    'age': 25,  
    'favorite_colors': ['blue', 'green'],  
    'active': True  
}
```

```
print(person.items())
```



- To iterate over all key-value pairs in a dictionary, you use a for loop with two variable key and value

```
person = {  
    'first_name': 'John',  
    'last_name': 'Doe',  
    'age': 25,  
    'favorite_colors': ['blue', 'green'],  
    'active': True  
}  
for key, value in person.items():  
    print(f"{key}: {value}")
```

Output:

```
first_name: John  
last_name: Doe  
age: 25  
favorite_colors: ['blue', 'green']  
active: True
```




2) Looping through all the keys in a dictionary

```
person = {  
    'first_name': 'John',  
    'last_name': 'Doe',  
    'age': 25,  
    'favorite_colors': ['blue', 'green'],  
    'active': True  
}  
for key in person.keys():  
    print(key)
```

Output:

```
first_name  
last_name  
age  
favorite_colors  
active
```



3) Looping through all the values in a dictionary:

```
person = {  
    'first_name': 'John',  
    'last_name': 'Doe',  
    'age': 25,  
    'favorite_colors': ['blue', 'green'],  
    'active': True  
}
```

```
for value in person.values():  
    print(value)
```

Output:

```
John  
Doe  
25  
['blue', 'green']  
True
```



Python Exception:

Exceptions:

- Even though when your code has valid syntax, it may cause an error during execution.
- In Python, errors that occur during the execution are called exceptions.
- The causes of exceptions mainly come from the environment where the code executes. For example:
- Reading a file that doesn't exist.
- Connecting to a remote server that is offline.
- Bad user inputs.
- When an exception occurs, the program doesn't handle it automatically. This results in an error message.



Handling exceptions:

- To make the program more robust, you need to handle the exception once it occurs.
- In other words, you need to catch the exception and inform users so that they can fix it.
- A good way to handle this is not to show what the Python interpreter returns. Instead, you replace that error message with a more user-friendly one.
- To do that, you can use the Python try...except statement:

try:

code that may cause error

except:

handle errors



The try...except statement works as follows:

- The statements in the try clause executes first.
- If no exception occurs, the except clause is skipped and the execution of the try statement is completed.
- If an exception occurs at any statement in the try clause, the rest of the clause is skipped and the except clause is executed.
- So to handle exceptions using the try...except statement, you place the code that may cause an exception in the try clause and the code that handles exception in the except clause.



Example:

```
a = int(input("Enter a:"))  
b = int(input("Enter b:"))  
c = a/b  
print("a/b = %d" %c)
```

#other code:

```
print("It is an example of exception in Python!")
```

Another Example:

try:

```
a = int(input("Enter a:"))  
b = int(input("Enter b:"))  
c = a/b
```

except:

```
print("Can't divide with zero")
```



We can also use the else statement with the try-except statement in which, we can place the code which will be executed in the scenario if no exception occurs in the try block.

try:

#block of code

except Exception1:

#block of code

else:

#this code executes if no except block is executed

try:

a = int(input("Enter a:"))

b = int(input("Enter b:"))

c = a/b

print("a/b = %d"%c)

Using exception object with the except statement

except Exception as e:

print("can't divide by zero")

print(e)

else:

print("Hi I am else block")



The try...finally block

- Python provides the optional finally statement, which is used with the try statement.
- It is executed no matter what exception occurs and used to release the external resource.
- The finally block provides a guarantee of the execution.

try:

```
# block of code  
# this may throw an exception
```

finally:

```
# block of code  
# this will always be executed
```

try:

```
fileptr = open("file2.txt", "r")
```

try:

```
fileptr.write("Hi I am good")
```

finally:

```
fileptr.close()
```

```
print("file closed")
```

except:

```
print("Error")
```




Raising exceptions:

- An exception can be raised forcefully by using the raise clause in Python.
- It is useful in that scenario where we need to raise an exception to stop the execution of the program.

Syntax

raise Exception_class, <value>

try:

```
num = int(input("Enter a positive integer: "))
```

```
if(num <= 0):
```

we can pass the message in the raise statement

```
    raise ValueError("That is a negative number!")
```

```
except ValueError as e:
```

```
    print(e)
```